

U.S. TAG to TC 301
Energy
Management
And
Energy Savings

Operating Procedure,
Code of Conduct and Procedures

EDITION: 2026

Based on 2025 ISO/IEC Directive 1 and the ANSI 2025 International Procedures.

For purposes of this document: Modifications to the ANSI Annex A procedure are shown in blue text.

U.S. Technical Advisory Group to ISO/TC 301
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1 General

The International Organization of Standardization (ISO) is a member based organization with over 185 countries participating in over 355 Technical Committees developing a wide array of voluntary standards. (Additional information can be found at <https://www.iso.org/about>). The member organization for the United States is the American National Standards Institute (ANSI). ANSI accredits U.S. Technical Advisory Groups (U.S. TAGs) to address specific technical topics.

These procedures for U.S. Technical Advisory Groups (U.S. TAGs) meet the requirements for due process and coordination in the development of U.S. positions for ISO activities as given in ANSI "*Criteria for the Development and Coordination of U.S. Positions in the International Standardization Activities of the ISO and IEC*." A U.S. TAG consists of its members and its U.S. TAG Administrator. A particular U.S. TAG is related to a particular ISO committee (e.g., "U.S. TAG for ISO/TC xx").

If a TAG is accredited by the ExSC to implement [this procedure](#), the TAG and TAG Administrator shall comply with all the provisions that follow, including Annex B and Annex C (or comparable) of the *ANSI International Procedures*. [This procedure applies to the ANSI-Accredited U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 for Energy Management and Energy Savings.](#)

Subgroups of U.S. TAGs or separate U.S. TAGs may be formed to relate to subcommittees of an ISO technical committee. Where the U.S. TAG to an ISO subcommittee is not independently accredited in accordance with 2.5.4 [Accreditation of U.S. TAGs for Subcommittees of ISO Technical Committees in ANSI Procedures For U.S. Participation in the International Standards Activities of ISO \(Hereafter referred to as ANSI Procedure\)](#), the degree of independent authority shall be defined in writing (as part of the TAG procedures, or as a policy or agreement) and shall be approved by the parent U.S. TAG, and a copy provided to ANSI. [No subgroups of the U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 Energy Management and Energy Savings have been formed at this time.](#)

PDDD, LLC is the U.S. TAG Administrator and that position is assigned to Deann Desai.

2 Functions and Responsibilities

2.1 Overview of ISO/TC 301

2.1.1 Overview of ISO/TC 301 Scope, Mission Statement, and Objectives

ISO Technical Committee 301 (ISO/TC 301) Scope

The ISO website (<https://www.iso.org/committee/6077221.html>) provides the scope of ISO/TC 301 as Standardization in the field of energy management and energy savings.

The ISO/TC 301 strategic plan provides the updated mission statement and objectives for ISO/TC 301 as:

[Mission Statement:](#)

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TC 301 will produce deliverables for managing energy and determining energy savings which enable users to effectively reduce their energy related emissions and demonstrate energy efficiency through improved energy performance, including the methods and approaches for measurement and verification of energy savings.

TC 301 will prioritize standards with broad international application and substantial impact on energy related emissions and decarbonization.

Objectives of ISO/TC 301

The deliverables provided by TC 301 can be used by organizations and entities of all sizes and types, groups, networks, cities, countries and regions. This scope includes:

- defining, establishing, implementing, and maintaining energy management systems;
- monitoring and measuring energy performance, especially to verify continual energy improvement;
- identifying, quantifying, verifying, validating and reporting energy performance improvements;
- guidance on energy management practices which improve energy security;
- defining and providing guidance on performing energy savings calculations;
- harmonizing energy management and energy savings terminology;
- establishing competency criteria and conformity assessment for the tasks in this field.

Energy is a key topic in the global community; changing energy use contributes to the efforts for reduction in Green House Gas (GHG), achieving net-zero emissions, and improving operational energy efficiency. ISO TC 301 is positioned to provide guidance to the global community in making the decisions needed to improve energy efficiency, change energy use and transition to a low carbon economy.

As the global community makes that transition, TC 301 can produce deliverables that facilitate:

- entities setting, accelerating, achieving, and demonstrating reductions in energy consumption and increasing decarbonization results,
- determining, adopting, implementing, verifying, and validating technology choices.
- providing guidance on competence within organizations providing confidence in the results achieved, and
- providing guidance on improving the energy supply chain and related trade-offs that need to be made to achieve the overall net -zero energy emissions goals.

ISO TC 301 is positioned to engage with entities to improve business processes, provide predictive and actual energy savings through relevant framework(s) for strategic decisions, systematic improvement, energy performance, management of energy data, and validation and verification.

2.1.2 Overview of the U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 Scope, Mission Statement, and Objectives

The scope of the ANSI Accredited TAG to ISO TC 301 Energy Management and Energy Savings is to assist and develop the U.S. position on standards in support of ISO TC 301. The U.S. TAG provides an opportunity for all affected U.S. constituencies (companies, government agencies, organizations [non-profit or educational institutions]), consultants, and individuals to help develop the U.S. position on ISO energy management and energy savings and energy related emissions concepts, related terminology, energy management audits, energy audits,

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energy measuring and monitoring, benchmarking, auditor competency, guidance, energy performance, continual improvement including identification, quantifying, validating and reporting energy performance improvements, and other related topics and supporting technologies and policies to support energy management, robust financial evaluation, evaluation of energy performance, potential improvements and energy savings and/or reduction in energy related emissions. The scope also addresses and considers joint work the IEC and with other ISO TCs, SCs, PCs, WGs and liaisons.

The U.S. TAG will support the objectives of ISO/TC 301 and using a consensus process promote the viewpoints of U.S. Stakeholders in the priorities and work of ISO/TC 301.

2.2 Functions and responsibilities of the U.S. TAG are:

The functions and responsibilities of the U.S. TAG, subject to ISO rules and limitations, are:

- Recommend registration of ANSI as a P- or O-member on an ISO committee, recommend a change in ANSI membership status on an ISO committee or recommend termination of membership as a P- or O- member on an ISO committee.
- Initiate and approve U.S. proposals for new work items for submission by ANSI for consideration by an ISO committee¹.
- Initiate and approve U.S. working drafts for submission by ANSI to ISO committees (and, where appropriate, Working Groups) for consideration as committee drafts².
- Determine the U.S. position on an ISO draft International Standard, draft technical report, committee drafts, ISO questionnaires, draft reports of meetings, etc.³
- Provide adequate U.S. representation to ISO committee meetings, designate heads of delegation and members of delegations, and ensure compliance with the *ANSI Guide for U.S. Delegates to ISO and IEC Meetings* (including preparation and submission of a Head of Delegation report by the designated Head of Delegation).
- Determine U.S. positions on agenda items of ISO committee meetings and advise the U.S. delegation of any flexibility it may have on these positions.
- Nominate U.S. technical experts to serve on ISO Working Groups.
- Provide assistance to U.S. secretariats of ISO committees, upon request, including resolving comments on draft international standards, draft technical reports, and committee drafts.
- Identify and establish close liaison with other U.S. TAGs in related fields or identify ISO or IEC activities that may overlap the U.S. TAG's scope.
- Recommend to ANSI the acceptance of secretariats for ISO committees.
- Recommend that ANSI invite the ISO committees to meet in the United States
- Recommend to ANSI U.S. candidates for the Chair of ISO committees and U.S. conveners of ISO Working Groups.

3 U.S. TAG Administrator

The U.S. TAG Administrator shall be designated by the ExSC and shall accept, in writing, the

¹ ISO proposals are assigned reference numbers by the ISO Central Secretariat, (ISO TS/P...).

² Ibid.

³ Ibid.

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responsibilities described below:

- Organizing the U.S. TAG and applying to ANSI for approval of the TAG Administrator and initial TAG membership list and accreditation of the TAG
- Submitting the U.S. TAG membership list, annual compliance form and annual report to ANSI by established deadlines for review by the ExSC or its designee
- Appointing members to the U.S. TAG
- Monitoring that the members of the U.S. TAG participate actively
- Providing for administrative services, including arrangements for meetings, timely preparation and distribution of documents related to the work of the U.S. TAG, and maintenance of appropriate records, including minutes of meetings and results of ballots
- Upon request by an interested party, making available⁴, the roster of the TAG including each member's name (or if membership is by organization, the name of the organization with a point of contact), affiliation and interest category, [in accordance with the privacy policies of this procedure](#)
- Transmitting U.S. proposals and U.S. positions, as developed and approved by the U.S. TAG, to ANSI
- Transmitting to ANSI U.S. delegates lists for all international meetings
- Establishing a procedure to hear appeals of actions or inactions of the U.S. TAG
- Establishing a written antitrust policy reflecting the TAG's practice to conduct all business and activity in compliance with applicable antitrust laws
- Complying with the requirements associated with ANSI oversight and supervision of activities of the U.S. TAG and its administration in accordance with 2.5.5 [Maintenance of Accreditation in ANSI Procedure](#)
- Monitoring compliance with applicable ANSI and ISO procedures
- Completing mandatory training offered by ANSI to support compliance with ANSI procedures
- governing the administration of the U.S. TAG and representation of U.S. interests at ISO
- Paying all relevant fees to ANSI
- Providing to ANSI three (3) months prior written notice if the organization that serves as the TAG Administrator is unable to continue to serve and intends to relinquish this role
- [Representing the U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 in ANSI forums](#)
- [Serving as liaison, or providing recommendations for the appointing of TAG member, to appropriate U.S. TAGs including but not limited to TC 176, 207, 302, ICAC, and MSS liaison group.](#)

[Deann Desai is the current TAG Administrator for the U.S. TAG to TC 301 Energy Management and Energy Savings.](#)

4 Officers

There shall be a TAG Chair, and other officers if required, appointed by the U.S. TAG Administrator from the individual members of the U.S. TAG, subject to approval by a majority vote of the U.S. TAG. Each will serve until a successor is selected and ready to serve. The secretary shall be appointed by the U.S. TAG Administrator. [The US TAG Administrator will](#)

⁴ The affiliation of a TAG member refers to the entity that the TAG member represents, which may or may not be that person's employer. If the TAG member is serving in an individual capacity, then the name of the individual, their sponsors (if any) and interest category shall be made available upon request. Contact information is not required. A sponsor is defined as an organization that provides funds specifically to support the individual's participation in the standards activities of the TAG.

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serve as the TAG Chair, if there not any nominations for the position, or TAG member(s) serving in that capacity.

4.1 Role of the TAG Chair

The Chair (or Cochairs) is a member of the TAG who also serves as the TAG's presiding officer, at the pleasure of the organization that serves as TAG Administrator. The Chair (or Cochairs) of the TAG is expected to fulfill the following important responsibilities:

- Preside over meetings of the U.S. TAG in a professional manner and in accordance with the accredited procedures of the TAG.
- Work with the TAG Administrator to ensure that decisions made by the TAG are implemented or advanced.
- Serve as a neutral convenor with respect to the work of the U.S. TAG. If a Chair wishes to advocate for a position, then they must give over the role of Chair to an impartial TAG member for the duration of such discussions.
- Preside over the productive work of the TAG while promoting an environment that encourages open, balanced and fact-based information sharing and debate, not dominated by any single interest, individual or topic.
- Be well versed in the accredited procedures of the TAG, ANSI's requirements for due process, ISO's Directives, the TAG's *Code of Conduct* and ISO's *Code of Conduct for the technical work*.
- Work with the TAG Administrator to establish the TAG's work program, meeting schedule and meeting agendas to advance the timely work and goals of the TAG.
- Serve as an impartial facilitator for the resolution of informal complaints, and if a formal appeal is to be considered, provide oversight to ensure fairness in the implementation of the TAG's appeals process, e.g., make decisions related to disputed conflict-of-interest claims.
- Work with the TAG Administrator to monitor compliance with and enforcement of the TAG's Code of Conduct.
- Other duties as described in these procedures or as necessary to ensure the smooth operation of the TAG in fulfillment of its role.

5 Membership

Membership shall be open to all U.S. National Interested Parties interested in the activity of the U.S. TAG, after being informed concerning U.S. TAG working procedures and scope of activities. There shall be no undue financial barriers to participation. Administrative fees may be charged by the TAG Administrator, but in all cases procedures for requesting a waiver or reduction of the fees must be available. Participation shall not be conditional upon membership in any organization or unreasonably restricted on the basis of technical qualifications or other such requirements.

The TAG Administrator shall be responsible for determining the membership of the TAG in accordance with Section A5.2 [Appointment](#) and the due process criteria (e.g., balance, lack of dominance, openness, etc.) set forth in Annex B of the *ANSI International Procedures*.

5.1 Application

A request for membership by a U.S. National Interested Party shall be addressed to the U.S. TAG Administrator, shall indicate the applicant's direct and material interest in the U.S. TAG's work and willingness to participate actively (see A5.8 in [Membership Obligation and Review of Membership in ANSI Procedures](#)) and the applicant's interest category based on their affiliation (if any). If the applicant is a representative of an organization, company, or government agency, and an alternate is desired, the alternate shall also be identified.

A Membership application that reflects the stated provisions of these procedures may be required as a condition of applying to serve as a voting member of the TAG. The application may require an explanation of the applicant's direct and material interest in the work of the TAG as well as submission of a resume or summary of relevant experience. All approved applicants shall agree to abide by the TAG's Code of Conduct.

5.2 Appointment

In appointing a new member, the TAG Administrator shall consider:

1. Interest categories represented in the TAG.
2. Balance on the TAG.
3. The extent of interest expressed by the applicant, and the applicant's willingness to participate actively.
4. [Professional conduct that conforms to the code of conduct and other requirements of membership.](#)
5. [Any past or current participation in U.S. TAGs.](#)

The U.S. TAG Administrator may consider reasonable limits on U.S. TAG size.

[Any TAG member who resigns or is removed from the organization forfeits all interest in U.S. TAG activities, Intellectual Property related to the activities of the TAG, and electronic resources.](#)

5.3 Intra-company Interest

If representatives from distinct divisions of an organization can demonstrate independent interests and authority to make independent decisions in the area of the activity of the U.S. TAG, each may apply for membership.

5.4 Combined Interests

When appropriate, the U.S. TAG Administrator may recommend that the applicant seek representation through an organization that is already represented by a member who represents the same or similar interests.

5.5 Observers

U.S. National Interested Parties having an interest in the U.S. TAG's work may request listing as

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observers. Observers shall be advised of the U.S. TAG activities, may attend meetings with prior approval, and may submit comments for consideration, but shall not vote. [The U.S. TAG may invite subject matter experts to participate in specific activities. These experts do not have voting rights but can provide input including comments for the consideration of the U.S. TAG members, when developing a U.S. position.](#)

5.6 Lack of Dominance

All U.S. National Interested Parties shall have the opportunity for fair and equitable participation without dominance by any single interest.

Dominance means a position or exercise of dominant authority, leadership, or influence by reason of superior leverage, strength, or representation. The requirement implicit in the phrase "without dominance by any single interest" normally will be satisfied if a reasonable balance among interests can be achieved. Unless it is claimed by a U.S. National Interested Party that a single interest dominated the standards activity, to the exclusion of fair and equitable consideration of other viewpoints, no test for dominance is required.

5.7 Membership Roster

The TAG Administrator shall maintain the list of U.S. TAG members and the organization (if any) they represent.

The roster shall include the following:

1. Title and designation of the U.S. TAG
2. Scope of the U.S. TAG
3. U.S. TAG Administrator (name of organization, name of secretary, address(es), telephone number)
4. U.S. TAG officers (Chair and other officers if different from the TAG Administrator and Secretary)
5. Members:
 - a) Names of the individuals and alternates (as applicable) and their business affiliations including name of the organization they are representing on the U.S. TAG
 - b) The interest category of each individual and alternate (as applicable)

[NOTE: Confidential information will be not be included in the membership roster.](#)

The interest categories are shown below:

Table 1: U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 Membership Interest Categories

Producer:	These members include but are not limited to energy services companies, equipment suppliers, and utilities.
User (Industrial and commerce, Government, labor, Consumers)	These members include but are not limited to commercial users, federal government, local government, manufacturers, service organizations and the military.
General Interest:	These members include but are not limited to associations, consultants, educational institutions, non-profits and regulatory agencies.

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(Academic and research bodies, Standards Applications, NGOs)	
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5.8 Membership Obligations and Review of Membership

Members are expected to participate actively by fulfilling attendance, voting, correspondence, and other obligations. Members are expected to participate in good faith and in accordance with professional standards, respectful of the rules of the TAG and the authority given to the Officers of the TAG and TAG Administrator. Approved TAG members shall agree to comply with the TAG's Code of Conduct, which must be consistent with the *ANSI International Procedures*. Annex C provides a sample Code of Conduct.

The U.S. TAG Administrator shall review the membership list annually with respect to the criteria of A5 [Membership in ANSI Procedure](#). TAG members who regularly and without good cause fail to attend meetings do not return ballots, or otherwise exhibit lack of interest or responsibility, may be removed for the stated causes, after one written warning of pending removal, by the TAG Administrator. TAG members who fail to comply with the TAG's Code of Conduct or, in connection with ISO meetings, ISO's Code of Conduct, are subject to removal by the TAG Administrator. Removal from TAG membership is subject to the TAG's appeals process.

As appropriate, the TAG and TAG Administrator may refer to Robert's Rules of Order, Disciplinary Procedures (or other comparable due-process-based rules), for guidance.

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We, the members and volunteers of the U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 Energy Management and Energy Savings, hereby agree that when acting on behalf of the U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 commit to as a requirement of our participation

Table 2 U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 Code of Conduct

Work for the benefit of the community	• Members will work with the highest professional standards, avoiding real or perceived conflicts of interest whenever possible and to disclose them to affected parties when they do exist • Members will work to the benefit of the community and not hinder the development of on-going approved work. • Members will work and communicate in a manner that is respectful of the U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 process(es), and membership of the U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301.
Professional behavior	• Members will demonstrate fairness, honesty, and openness, and treat all other members with dignity and respect. • Members will act kindly towards one another and will not stoop to harassing behaviors or making inappropriate or disparaging remarks. Acts of harassment or violence will not be tolerated. • Members are expected to show the highest level of integrity and ethical conduct by acting in a genuine and responsible manner and expressing opinions that consider the stakeholder needs of the U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301.
Uphold consensus	• The process of the TAG is a consensus process, which means that not all comments will be incorporated or submitted for international consideration. By participating in the TAG, you acknowledge that you will accept the decision of the majority; even if that means individual comments are rejected. • Delegates who represent the TAG internationally agree to represent the agreed consensus position and not their individual comments.

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Behave ethically	• Members will act in good faith and with due care and diligence. • Members will avoid collusive or anticompetitive behavior. • Members will promote an atmosphere of collaboration.
Conflict of Interest and Confidentiality	• Members will refrain from disclosing confidential information acquired through TAG membership, except when authorized or legally obligated to do so. • Members will inform affiliates, as appropriate, regarding the confidentiality of information acquired through TAG membership and monitor the affiliate activities to assure the maintenance of that confidentiality. • Members will avoid actual or apparent conflicts of interest and advise all appropriate parties of any potential conflict. • Members will recognize and communicate professional limitations or other constraints that would preclude responsible judgment or successful performance of an activity. • Members will communicate information fairly and objectively.
Respect others in meetings (in person and electronic)	Members will respect others and the professional culture of the TAG. In meetings members will: ❖ Act in a professional manner ❖ Respect others and their opinions ❖ Accept group decisions • Ensure that the various views are heard through active listening
Financial resources	• Members will hold the TAG leadership accountable for proper use of funds. • Resources will be used efficiently and in a cost-effective manner to maximize impact • Funding and spending will follow legal regulations. • Financial decisions will be made free from personal gain or undue influence.

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5.8.1 Review of Membership Principles in support of the TAG Member Code of Conduct

5.8.1.1 Openness

Participation shall be open to all U.S. National Interested Parties. Participation shall not be conditional upon membership in any organization, or unreasonably restricted based on technical qualifications.

Timely and adequate notice of the formation of new activities related to international standards will be provided including a description of the purpose of the proposed activity. The TAG Administrator is responsible for TAG communications regarding current, new and on-going projects and other news of potential interest to TAG members.

5.8.1.2 Balance

The U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 strives to provide opportunities that are fair and equitable without dominance by any single interest. Dominance means a position or exercise of dominant authority, leadership or influence by reason of superior leverage, strength or representation. TAG members are classified in one of the interest categories based on the business or other interests of their employers or sponsors they represent in connection with the standards development activity (see 5.7 Table 1 for the defined interest categories).

5.8.1.3 Financial resources

TAG members are requested to support the financial needs for the U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301. The cost to have an accredited U.S. TAG includes three basic components. ANSI fees, International Participation, and TAG meetings and support.

A. Fees for ANSI:

ANSI fees are **annual fees** composed of the following components:

Required Component	TAG only	TAG and ASD*
Member fee	\$1,300.00	\$4,275.00
Secretariat Fee	\$13,000.00	\$13,000.00
P Membership* Per Committee and Subcommittee	\$6,586.00	\$6,586.00
Activity fee	\$575.00	\$575.00
ASD Application fee		\$5,000
National Activity fee		\$3,220.00 (up to 3 national adoptions), \$6,960.00 (up to 54 national adoptions)

* ASD stands for Accredited Standards Developer. An ASD can write American National Standards and can adopt ISO standards as American National Standards.

There is typically an annual increase in the range of 2 to 7% per year with details available at the link:

[https://www.ansi.org/membership/member-categories/additional-assessment-fees](https://www ansi.org/membership/member-categories/additional-assessment-fees)

B. Cost associated with effective international participation in the ISO work:

- 1) International participation in the meetings to represent the U.S. position and address comments that may not align with the U.S. position. This includes the TC 301 Leadership team from the U.S.

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- 2) Costs to have face-to-face and hybrid meetings for TAG members to discuss situations, status, develop and determine U.S. comments and positions, as well as strategy for experts, meetings, and future TAG activities. TAG Meeting costs for hybrid or face-to-face meetings incur costs of approximately \$10,000 to cover the meeting rooms, AV equipment, internet access, and food.

TAG members are asked to support the TAG financial needs, if you have any questions please contact the TAG Administrator.

5.9 Member responsibilities

5.9.1 Response to TAG Communications

Membership provides the privilege of receiving documents being produced by TC 301 or related to the work of TC 301. ISO/TC 301 communications, documents, liaison activities or other information are circulated for comment or other action at the discretion of the TAG Administrator.

The TAG member is responsible for responding as requested by the TAG Administrator (See 5.8 above).

5.9.1.1 Comments

Through the ISO development process and liaison requests there will be opportunities to provide comments on ISO documents. In many cases there will be multiple opportunities to comment on a document as it develops. ISO uses two methods currently to gather comments. One is the ISO word template, the other is the On-line Standards Development Platform. Instructions for which method and the details related to that method will be provided to TAG members for each comment opportunity. A timeframe for responses will be provided to return comments. If the timeline is missed, the comments are not likely to be included.

Submission of a comment does not mean it will be included in the U.S. position. Past U.S. positions, past international discussions, and related work are also considered in the development of the U.S. position. The TAG Administrator has the responsibility to review and submit the final comments for the U.S. position based on the overall goals of the TAG for that project and related work.

5.9.1.2 Ballots

Ballots are conducted for several reasons including but not limited to approval of the U.S. Position, approval of ISO/TC 301 resolutions, Committee Internal Ballots (CIB) issued by ISO/TC 301, it's related groups, or liaisons. A timeframe for responding to the letter ballot is provided when it is issued. If a response is received late, it may not be included in the TAG position, but can be considered for TAG participation.

The final position for documents is determined either through a letter ballot vote or a ballot taken during a TAG meeting. In addition, the principles of the *ANSI Procedures for U.S. Participation in the International Standards Activities of ISO* are also considered.

The Principles include:

1. If there is an existing U.S. national standard (i.e., an ANS or, in the absence of an ANS, another standard generally accepted within the United States) and:
 - If the national standard can be considered equivalent to the requirements in the international document, vote affirmative
 - If the international document includes different, additional, or more stringent requirements than are in the national standard and the U.S. consensus indicates that such requirements are:

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- o Acceptable, and should be considered for inclusion in the national standard, vote affirmative, or
 - o Not acceptable, vote negative
- If the national standard includes different, additional, or more stringent requirements than are in the international document and the U.S. consensus indicates that such requirements:
 - o Should be modified in accordance with the international document, vote affirmative or,
 - o Must be maintained, vote negative, or
 - o Must be maintained, but the proposed document is considered to represent the best agreement which can be attained at the present time from an international point of view, vote abstain with a statement that the U.S. cannot modify its national standard for stated reasons.
- 2. If no national standard exists and
 - If the U.S. consensus establishes that the international document is:
 - o Technically acceptable and could be used as the basis for the development of a national standard, vote affirmative, or
 - o Not technically acceptable, vote negative.
 - If the international document is of little or no interest to the U.S., abstain
 - If the international document unnecessarily creates a barrier to domestic or international trade or impedes innovation or technical progress, vote negative
- 3. If no U.S. consensus has been established or no comments are received (indicating a lack of current interest), a vote of abstain is entered.
- 4. The U.S. vote, if negative, must be accompanied by reasons and supporting information such as technical data and logical argument. Also, any known exceptions and/or additions that will be required to conform to U.S. safety practices or regulations shall be noted.

Consensus for a U.S. position is established when substantial agreement has been reached by the U.S. national interests that are directly and materially affected by the proposed international standard. Additionally, if the proposed U.S. position is based on considering changes in an existing U.S. national standard, the consensus process shall include U.S. national interests that are directly and materially affected by the U.S. national standard.

6 Meetings

Meetings of the U.S. TAG and meetings of the U.S. delegates to international meetings should be scheduled to respond to international activities.

Participation in TAG meetings provides an opportunity to learn the status of activities and the TAG, help develop the U.S. position, and to network with other TAG members. Every effort will be made to provide sufficient notice of meetings. TAG meetings will be either virtual or hybrid.

U.S. TAG meetings shall be held, as determined by the U.S. TAG Administrator or by petition of a majority of the members. U.S. TAGs shall determine for themselves the quorum requirements. The quorum requirements for the U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 are thirty percent (30%) of the membership roster present in the meeting for a ballot or 30% of membership responding to a letter ballot.

If a TAG member has been confirmed as an expert to ISO/TC 301 or a liaison committee, they are responsible for registering for WG or Task Group meetings in the ISO meeting portal. However, plenary meetings will be managed by the TAG Administrator in conjunction with ANSI, meaning TAG members should not self-register for plenary meetings in the ISO meeting portal.

6.1 Open Meetings

Meetings of the U.S. TAG shall be open to all members and other U.S. National Interested Parties approved in advance by the Chair or the TAG Administrator. At least four weeks' notice of [hybrid](#) meetings should be given by the TAG Administrator and shall be announced in ANSI's *Standards Action* or suitable media designed to reach directly and materially affected interests. The notice shall describe the purpose of the meeting and shall identify a readily available source for further information. An agenda shall be available and shall be distributed in advance of the meeting to members and to others expressing interest.

During TAG meetings the following topics will NOT be addressed:

- License terms, price or any elements of price or pricing policy (this includes costs, discounts, terms and conditions of sale);
- Direct or indirect sales, production quotas, territories, or market shares;
- Identified individual company statistics, inventories, or merchandising methods;
- Particular competitors or customers;
- Commercial liabilities, warranties, guarantees, or the particular terms and conditions of sales, including credit, shipping and transportation arrangements;
- Anything dealing with persuasion related to, excluding, or controlling competition.

7 Voting

7.1 Vote

Each member shall vote one of the following positions:

- Affirmative
- Affirmative with comment ([if applicable](#))
- Negative with reasons (In all but administrative matters, the reasons for a negative vote shall be given and if possible, should include specific wording or actions which would resolve the objection.)
- [Accept the expert recommendation \(if applicable\)](#)
- Abstain with reason

7.2 Vote of Alternate

An alternate's vote is counted only if the principal representative fails to vote.

7.3 Voting Period

The voting period for ballots shall be established to allow for timely response to international time limits. An extension may be granted at the option of the Chair or TAG Administrator when warranted (e.g., when the requirements for approval or disapproval specified by A7.5 or A7.6 are not achieved); [any extension must be within the international time limit. Ballots may be taken in TAG meetings or issued as a letter ballot based on the decision of the TAG Administrator.](#)

7.4 Authorization of Ballots

A ballot may be authorized by:

1. Majority vote of those present at a U.S. TAG meeting
2. The U.S. TAG Chair
3. The U.S. TAG Administrator
4. Petition of five members of the U.S. TAG or a majority of the U.S. TAG, whichever is less

7.5 Actions Requiring Approval by Majority

The following actions require a ballot or an equivalent formal recorded vote with approval by at least a [simple](#) majority of the U.S. TAG membership:

- Approval of officers appointed by the TAG Administrator, which may or may not have been
- nominated by members of the U.S. TAG
- Formation of a subgroup, including its procedures, scope, and duties
- Disbandment of a subgroup
- Approval of meeting reports
- Other actions of the committee not specified elsewhere

7.6 Actions Requiring Approval by Two-Thirds of Those Voting

The following actions must be approved by at least two-thirds of those voting by ballot, excluding abstentions, or if at a meeting, by two-thirds of those present, excluding abstentions, provided that a majority of the total voting membership of the U.S. TAG is present. If a majority is not present, the vote shall be confirmed by ballot.

- Adoption of U.S. TAG procedures, categories of interests, or revisions thereof
- Approval of recommendation to change the U.S. TAG scope, which must reflect the scope of the related ISO committee (or equivalent)
- Approval of U.S. position on technical matters brought before the U.S. TAG (i.e., NP, CD, DIS, FDIS, or other ISO deliverable)
- Approval of recommendation to terminate the U.S. TAG

The TAG Administrator shall report successful ballots on items 1, 2 and 4 to the ExSC, along with its views on the action.

A summary of the voting requirements is shown below for your use:

Approval by Simple Majority	Approval by 2/3 Majority
Approval of officers appointed by the TAG Administrator	Adoption and revision of U.S. TAG Procedures
Formation/disbandment of a U.S. TAG Subgroup	Approval to change scope of the U.S. TAG
Approval of meeting report	Approval of U.S. positions on technical matters
Other actions of the committee not specified elsewhere	Approval of recommendation to terminate the U.S. TAG.

7.7 Consideration of Views and Objections on Ballots

The Administrator of the U.S. TAG shall forward the views and objections received to the Chair of the U.S. TAG, or their designee. The Chair shall determine whether the expressed views and objections shall be considered by telephone, correspondence, or at a meeting.

Prompt consideration shall be given to the expressed views and objections of all participants including those commenting on a draft international standard (DIS) listing in *Standards Action*. A concerted effort to resolve all expressed objections shall be made, and each objector shall be advised of the disposition of the objection and the reasons therefor.

Material changes to a proposed U.S. position or proposed U.S. comments required to resolve objections, and unresolved objections to the proposed U.S. position or proposed U.S. comments, shall be reported to the U.S. TAG members to afford all members an opportunity within appropriate time limits to respond, to reaffirm, or to change their position. A material change is one that alters or modifies the U.S. position or the intent of the U.S. comments at issue.

7.8 Report of Final Result

The final result of the voting shall be reported to the U.S. TAG.

7.9 Submittal of U.S. Position

Upon completion of the procedures for voting, consideration of views and objections, and appeals, the U.S. position, which represents the U.S. consensus, shall be submitted to ANSI by the U.S. TAG Administrator. ANSI, as the official ISO member body, is responsible for providing the U.S. position to ISO.⁵

7.10 Information Submitted

The information supplied to ANSI shall include:

- Title and designation of the document
- Indication of the type of action requested (for example, approval of a new draft international standard or reaffirmation, revision, or withdrawal of an existing draft international standard, questionnaire, etc.)
- Status of any appeal action related to approval of the proposed U.S. position
- A summary of the voting and U.S. TAG member responses
- Identification of all unresolved views and objections, names of the objector(s), and a report of attempts toward resolution.

Note: For documents that are using the OSD, the information submitted to ANSI is a copy of the final comment file and confirmation the comments were submitted in the OSD in addition to the information above.

7.11 Records

Records shall be prepared and maintained to provide evidence of compliance with this TAG procedure. Records concerning new, revised, or reaffirmed ISO Standards shall be retained for one complete cycle, or until the standard is revised. Records concerning withdrawn standards shall be retained for at least five years from the date of withdrawal.

⁵ ISO proposals are assigned reference numbers by the ISO Central Secretariat, (ISO TS/P...)

8 Termination of the U.S. TAG

A proposal to terminate a U.S. TAG may be made by a U.S. National Interested Party. The proposal shall be submitted in writing to ANSI and to the U.S. TAG Administrator and shall include the reasons why the U.S. TAG should be terminated. The U.S. TAG shall take action in accordance with A7.6. In the event that the U.S. holds the secretariat for an ISO committee for which the U.S. TAG is considering termination, the organization serving as secretariat shall be informed promptly and shall submit their position regarding termination of the TAG to ANSI and to the TAG Administrator.

As a result of action taken in accordance with A.7.6, should termination of the TAG be approved, notification of such action shall be announced in *Standards Action*. The announcement shall note that dissolution of the TAG will result in the U.S. relinquishing its P- (participant) status in the international activity. Also, if the U.S. serves as international secretariat, the announcement shall state that the U.S. will resign as international secretariat. The appropriate notification(s) shall be sent by ANSI to ISO Central Secretariat regarding the change in status, and the relinquishment of the secretariat, if applicable.

9 Communications

External communications such as inquiries relating to the U.S. TAG shall be directed to the U.S. TAG Administrator for response, and members should so inform individuals who raise such questions. All replies to inquiries shall be made through the U.S. TAG Administrator.

10 Appeals

U.S. National Interested Parties who believe they have been or will be adversely affected by a procedural action or inaction of the U.S. TAG, or its TAG Administrator shall have the right to appeal. Procedural appeals include whether a technical issue was afforded due process.

10.1 Complaint

The appellant shall file a written complaint with the U.S. TAG Administrator within fifteen (15) working days after the date of notification of action or within a reasonable time after becoming aware of the inaction and within the current standard development cycle. The complaint shall state the nature of the objection(s) including any adverse effects, the section(s) of these procedures or the specific actions or inactions that are at issue, and the specific remedial action(s) that would satisfy the appellant's concerns. Previous efforts to resolve the objection(s) and the outcome of each shall be noted.

A procedural complaint concerning the development of a U.S. position is expected to be filed in a timely manner, in sufficient time to allow the U.S. to cast its vote. The TAG Administrator is expected to take all reasonable efforts to ensure that procedural appeals are considered in a timely manner so that the resolution of an appeal can conclude prior to submission of a timely U.S. position/vote.

1. Appeals should not be filed by aggrieved parties late in the process simply to delay the submission of a U.S. vote to ISO; the standards development process through ISO provides ample opportunity for issues to be vetted and adjudicated during the development process rather than at the final voting stage.
2. The filing of an appeal does not automatically require the stay of an action or vote, if the time required to conclude the TAG appeals process would preclude the U.S. from submitting an

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approved timely vote or position.

[Note: There is TAG investigation form for complaints.](#)

When international deadlines preclude the use of routine appeals procedures, the TAG Chair in consultation with the Appeals Panel Chair, other officers or Appeals Panel Members, will establish an expedited mechanism and schedule for consideration of the appeal in a manner that they deem fair and reasonable. Such an alternative expedited mechanism is subject to further review by the ANSI ExSC, should an appeal of the decision be filed with ANSI. The expedited mechanism shall include full and fair consideration of the written filings.

10.2 Response

Within twenty-one (21) calendar days after receipt of the complaint, the TAG Administrator (respondent) shall respond in writing to the appellant, specifically addressing each allegation of fact in the complaint to the extent of the respondent's knowledge.

10.3 Hearing

If the appellant is not satisfied with the response of the respondent, they shall so inform the U.S. TAG Administrator within fifteen (15) calendar days. The U.S. TAG Administrator shall schedule a hearing with an appeals panel on a date agreeable to all participants, giving at least fifteen (15) calendar days' notice. Panel members and all parties shall receive a copy of the appeals record at least fifteen (15) calendar days prior to the date of the appeals hearing. The name and affiliation of all speakers and any observers, if allowed, shall be provided to the TAG Administrator in advance of the hearing by a date certain.

10.4 Appeals Panel

The appeals panel shall be appointed by the U.S. TAG Chair and shall consist of three individuals who have not been directly involved in the matter in dispute, and who will not be materially or directly affected by any decision made or to be made in the dispute. Members of the TAG that voted on an issue under appeal may not serve on a related appeals panel. At least two members shall be acceptable to the appellant and at least two shall be acceptable to the respondent. Unresolved claims of a conflict of interest against a potential panelist shall be decided by the TAG Chair after a review of each party's written concerns. If a panel cannot be agreed upon within fifteen (15) calendar days, the TAG Chair working with the TAG Administrator may appoint an impartial panel, taking any prior conflict of interest concerns stated by the parties into account. The names and affiliations of the panel shall be provided to the parties to the appeal.

10.5 Conduct of the Hearing

The appellant has the burden of demonstrating adverse effects, improper actions, or inactions and the efficacy of the requested remedial action. The respondent has the burden of demonstrating that the TAG and the U.S. TAG Administrator took all actions in compliance with these procedures and applicable ISO procedures, and that the requested remedial action would be ineffective or detrimental.

If a virtual or in-person hearing is held, the appellant's position shall be presented first, followed by the respondent. Each side is then allowed to respond until their total allotted time is exhausted. A half hour total, for the initial presentation and subsequent responses, is allotted for each side, with a limit of three speakers per side. Additional time is allotted for a question-and-answer session directed by the panel. At the hearing, speakers are not permitted to make

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assertions about facts or issues not in the record. The hearing may not be recorded in any way. At the close of the question-and-answer period, the appeals panel will enter Executive (closed) Session for the purpose of arriving at a decision.

Otherwise, the decision of the panel shall be based on the written submissions on record, supplemented by any written questions issued by the panel and responded to by the party or parties to whom the questions were directed.

10.6 Decision

The appeals panel shall render its decision in writing within thirty (30) calendar days, stating findings of fact and conclusions, with reasons therefor, based on a preponderance of the evidence. Consideration may be given to the following positions, among others, in formulating the decision:

1. Finding for the appellant and remanding the action to the U.S. TAG or the U.S. TAG Administrator with a specific statement of the issues and facts in regard to which fair and equitable action was not taken
2. Finding for the respondent with a specific statement of the facts that demonstrate fair and equitable treatment of the appellant and the appellant's objections
3. Finding that new, substantive evidence has been introduced and remanding the entire action to the U.S. TAG or the U.S. TAG Administrator for appropriate reconsideration

10.7 Further Appeal

An appeal of a U.S. TAG appeals decision may be filed with the ExSC in accordance with the Operating Procedures of the ANSI Executive Standards Council.

10.8 Informal Settlement

ANSI encourages settlement of disputes at any time if the settlement is consistent with the objectives of the *ANSI International Procedures*. Any settlement to which the parties agree in writing, that is consistent with these procedures, or an agreement to withdraw the appeal, will terminate the appeal process.

11 Antitrust Policy

U.S. positions developed by ANSI-Accredited U.S. TAGs shall be developed in accordance with applicable antitrust and competition laws and meetings amongst competitors to develop U.S. positions are to be conducted in accordance with these laws.

12 Parliamentary Procedures

On questions of parliamentary procedures not covered in these procedures, Robert's Rules of Order (or other comparable due-process-based meeting rules and practices) may be used for guidance.

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Member Data Protection Policy

The U.S. TAG to TC 301 collects personal data from people involved in the TAG and standardization work through its IT tools and services. In the TAG context, "Personal Data" includes a person's or identifiable person's names, email addresses, physical addresses, telephone numbers and member type (User, Generator, etc.) that are collected and used for reporting to ANSI or ISO per the approved TAG procedures. Due to the nature of Standards work and the structure of ANSI and ISO, this Personal Data is likely to be used (i.e. in a legal sense "transferred" and "processed") in and outside the U.S.A. and the territory of Switzerland by the ISO Central Secretariat (ISO/CS), TAG Members, third parties and other individuals associated with ISO activities in a variety of countries in the world.

- 1) As a TAG Member, you are responsible for protecting Personal Data in accordance with this Policy even if you give access to this Personal Data to:
 - people within your organization;
 - third Parties (including sub-organizations, agents, subcontractors, etc.) outside your organization;
 - others through computer interfaces.
- 2) As a TAG Member, you must:
 - Ensure that the people whose Personal Data you collect and use*:
 - understand that the TAG and ISO and its members are bound by a Policy protecting the personal data of everyone participating in the U.S. TAG to ISO/TC 301 and the ISO system;
 - consent to their Personal Data being collected, used, shared and archived for the development of standardization and related activities;
 - agree that their Personal Data could be transferred to countries with laws that may not guarantee the same level of data protection as the U.S. or Switzerland (where ISO/CS is based); and
 - know that TAG officers and the ISO Data Protection Officer are available to answer any questions about the content and purpose of their Personal Data.
 - Ensure that the people you allow access to Personal Data*:
 - agree to use the Personal Data they access only for the development of TAG activities as it relates to the standardization and related activities in the world with a view (i) to facilitating international exchange of goods and services and (ii) to develop cooperation in the spheres of intellectual, scientific, technological and economic activity (ISO's Purpose);
 - agree to respect relevant TAG rules and any applicable laws; and
 - understand that they remain bound by these obligations even after their participation in the TAG activities related to standards development work ends.

If they don't agree with the conditions in clause 1 and 2 above let us know so the information can be removed from the TAG electronic records.

- 3) Collect, use, share and archive (i.e. "process") Personal Data solely to promote and improve the development of standardization and related activities and services with a view (i) to facilitating international exchange of goods and services and (ii) to developing cooperation in the spheres of intellectual, scientific, technological and economic activity – this means

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that Personal Data cannot be collected and used for commercial purposes unless the person concerned has also explicitly given permission for this to TAG;

- 4) Undertake appropriate technical and organizational measures to protect Personal Data prior to processing it;
- 5) Immediately inform the person to whom the Personal Data relates and the TAG if you cannot comply with this Policy;
- 6) Immediately inform and cooperate with the TAG in case of any accidental or unauthorized access;
- 7) Ensure that Personal Data is kept up-to-date and deleted, as appropriate, the older data;
- 8) Fully and quickly cooperate with the TAG in fulfilling information requests by people whose Personal Data we hold, and the TAG undertakes to fully and quickly cooperate with TAG Members that receive information request;
- 9) If you cease to be a TAG Member, destroy any Personal Data and copies thereof to which this Policy applies and certify its destruction to the TAG in writing or via email.
- 10) Ensure that your employees and any third parties entering or accessing Personal Data on your behalf accept this Policy or equivalent or stricter terms. In all cases, you remain responsible for compliance with this Policy by such third parties.

Responsibility for the protection of Personal Data lies with TAG Members, who are also accountable to one another. Any TAG Member with concerns about the practices of another TAG Member should contact that Member and inform the TAG Administrator.

The TAG may require ISO Members to terminate the access of third parties in case of doubt regarding compliance with this Policy.

Any data protection and related laws to which TAG Members are normally subject to continue to apply. This Policy adds to, and does not replace, such laws. Where national data protection laws offer equal or stricter protection, they can override this, Policy. Members are obliged to report other conflicts between this Policy and laws to which they are subject.

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Revision	Change summary	Date change approved	New Revision
Initial issue		TAG approved 15 May 2026	Initial